

Brent Pappas

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Portfolio: <https://www.pappasbrent.com>

GitHub: <https://www.github.com/PappasBrent>

EDUCATION

PhD. Computer Science. GPA: 3.983. University of Central Florida. Orlando, Florida. August 2021 - Present.

Master of Science. Computer Science. GPA: 3.983. University of Central Florida. Orlando, Florida. August 2021 - December 2025.

Bachelor of Science. Computer Science. GPA: 3.849. University of Central Florida. Orlando, Florida. August 2017 - May 2021.

TEACHING

Spring 2026	Instructor of Record. COP-3402 Systems Software. UCF. Course homepage . Lecture Recordings . Mean average teaching evaluation score: 4.62/5 . 164/250 enrolled students responded. Department mean was 4.24, college mean 4.21. Student ratings . Student comments .
Fall 2025	Graduate Teaching Assistant. COP-3402 Systems Software. UCF. Mean average overall teaching evaluation score: 4.93/5 . 15 students responded. Student perception of instruction .
Spring 2025	Graduate Teaching Assistant. COP-3402 Systems Software. UCF.
Spring 2021	Peer Tutor Mentor. COP-3502 Computer Science 1 & COP-3330 Object Oriented Programming. UCF.
Spring & Fall 2020	Peer Tutor. COP-3502 Computer Science 1 & COP-3330 Object Oriented Programming. UCF.
Fall 2019	Peer Tutor. COP-3502 Computer Science 1. UCF.

PUBLICATIONS

- 2026 Build Code is Still Code: Finding the Antidote for Pipeline Poisoning:** by Brent Pappas and Paul Gazzillo. ICSE NIER. Acceptance rate of 33.11% (50 / 151). [Pre-print](#). [Artifact](#). Badges: Available and reusable. [Presentation](#). [Slides](#).
- 2024 Semantic Analysis of Macro Usage for Portability:** by Brent Pappas and Paul Gazzillo. ICSE. Acceptance rate of 22.26% (234 / 1051). [Pre-print](#). [Artifact](#). Badges: Available and reusable. [Presentation](#). [Slides](#).
- 2023 Holy Macroni! A recipe for progressive language enhancement:** by Brent Pappas. Blog post for Trail of Bits. [Blog post](#). [Artifact](#).
- 2022 SugarC: Scalable Desugaring of Real-World Preprocessor Usage into Pure C:** by Zach Patterson, Zenong Zhang, Brent Pappas, Shiyi Wei, and Paul Gazzillo. ICSE. Acceptance rate of 28.51% (197 / 691). [Pre-print](#). [Artifact](#). Badges: Available and reusable. [Presentation](#).

SERVICE

June 2026	Camp Connect Lab Leader. Orlando, Florida.
March 2026	NAC - NAPC Volunteer. Orlando, Florida.
October 2025	UCF CS Grad Symposium 2025 Student Panelist. Orlando, Florida.
August 2025	UCF GradLaunch PhD Panelist. Orlando, Florida.
August 2025	UCF "Surviving Graduate School" Panelist. Orlando, Florida.
June 2025	Camp Connect Lab Leader. Orlando, Florida.
May 2025	UCF Graduate School Info Session PhD Panelist. Orlando, Florida.
April 2024	UCF CECS Senior Design Judge. Orlando, Florida.
October 2022	UCF CECS Career Kickoff Alumni Mentor. Virtual.
May 2024	Orlando, Florida.
2024	OOPLSA 2024 Artifact Evaluation Committee Member. Virtual.

June 2023 **Camp Connect Lab Leader.** Orlando, Florida.
Nov - Dec 2022 **EuroSys 2023 Shadow Program Committee Member.** Virtual.
June 2021 **Camp Connect Lab Leader.** Orlando, Florida.

PRESENTATIONS

2026 **Build Code is Still Code: Finding the Antidote for Pipeline Poisoning.** Presentation at the 2026 International Conference on Software Engineering in Rio de Janeiro, Brazil. [YouTube recording](#). [Slides](#).
2026 **Curing Pipeline Poisoning.** 3 minute thesis on my research on securing build systems against pipeline poisoning with build phase isolation. Presented at the CRA 2026 Grad Cohort Workshop. [Recording link](#).
2026 **Invited Talk - The PhD Life.** Guest lecture on graduate student life presented to Sonoma State University's 2026 Spring Colloquium, hosted by Dr. John Sullins. [Slides](#).
2025 **Invited Talk - The PhD Life.** Guest lecture on graduate student life presented to Dr. Suzanne Rivoire's undergraduate course, Computing Professions, at Sonoma State University. [Slides](#).
2024 **Semantic Analysis of Macro Usage for Portability (ICSE 2024).** Presentation at the 2024 International Conference on Software Engineering in Lisbon, Portugal. [Recording](#).
2023 **Semantic Analysis of Macro Usage for Portability (CAE-R)** Virtual presentation for Center of Academic Excellence in Cyber Research (CAE-R). [Recording](#); [jump to 25:38](#).

POSTERS

2024 Holy Macroni! Finding Macro Usage Errors in the Linux Kernel. 2024 International Symposium on Secure and Private Execution Environment Design. [Link](#).
2022 Cpp2C: Transforming C Preprocessor Macros to C Language Constructs. 2022 University of Central Florida Student Scholar Symposium. [Link](#).

HONORS AND AWARDS

2026 **GTA Excellence Award (University level).** For providing exceptional teaching assistance to the course Systems Software. Awarded to 1 out of 800+ graduate teaching assistants. [Award letter](#).
2026 **GTA Excellence Award (College level).** For providing exceptional teaching assistance to the course Systems Software. [Award letter](#).
2026 **CRA-WP 2026 Grad Cohort Workshop Invitee.** The CRA-WP arranged and paid for me to travel to the 2026 CRA-WP Grad Cohort Workshop in Seattle, Washington, because of my superior workshop application.
2024 **UCF 3MT Finalist.** For effectively communicating my research to a general audience in a 3 minute talk. [Video](#). [Certificate](#).
2024 **Distinguished Artifact Reviewer.** For my attention to detail while reviewing artifacts for OOPSLA 2024. [Link](#).
2024 **FCI Student Scholarship.** For my interest in interdisciplinary research, scholarship, and collaboration. \$5000 award.
2021 **Cum laude honors.** For having a cumulative undergraduate GPA greater than 3.8.
2017 - 2021 **Deans' list.** For continued undergraduate scholastic achievement.
2017 **Burnett Honors Scholar.** For academic talent, motivation, intellectual curiosity and creativity.
2017 **Provost Scholarship.** For outstanding academic performance in high school. Completely covered my undergraduate tuition fees at the University of Central Florida.

CERTIFICATIONS

[Completed higher education training, Preparing Tomorrow's Faculty](#)
[Level 1 College Readiness and Learning Assessment \(CRLA\) certified tutor.](#)
[Level 2 College Readiness and Learning Assessment \(CRLA\) certified tutor.](#)
UCF Student Enhancement Training (SET) program certified.

WORKSHOPS

March 2026	2026 CRA-WP Grad Cohort Workshop. Seattle, Washington.
Oct - Nov 2025	2025 CRA-WP Virtual Mentoring Series Workshops. Virtual.
May 2025	2025 CRA-E Career Landscape Workshop. Virtual.
June 2022	Programming Language Mentoring Workshop (PLMW). San Diego, California.

COMPLETE WORK EXPERIENCE

Jan 2026 - Present	Graduate Teaching Associate (Instructor of Record) for COP-3402 Systems Software University of Central Florida. Orlando, Florida.
Jun 2025 - Dec 2025	Graduate Research Assistant University of Central Florida. Orlando, Florida.
Aug 2024 - May 2025	Graduate Research Assistant University of Central Florida. Orlando, Florida.
Aug 2023 - Apr 2024	Graduate Teaching Assistant for COP-3402 Systems Software University of Central Florida. Orlando, Florida.
May 2023 - Aug 2023	Software Engineering Intern Trail of Bits. Remote.
Jul 2021 - May 2023	Graduate Research Assistant University of Central Florida. Orlando, Florida.
Sep 2019 - Jul 2021	Quality Assurance Coordinator SP+. Orlando, Florida.
Jan 2021 - May 2021	Peer Tutor Mentor Student Academic Resource Center at the University of Central Florida. Orlando, Florida.
Aug 2018 - May 2021	Peer Tutor Student Academic Resource Center at the University of Central Florida. Orlando, Florida.

ADVISING

UNDERGRADUATE RESEARCHERS

Aaron Burgess. 2026 - Present. Human factors in software engineering.

Thiago Airoidi. 2026 - Present. Analysis and security of software development pipelines.

Rasmin Ahmed. 2026 - Present. Analysis and security of software development pipelines.

Daniel Henriquez. 2026 - Present. Analysis and security of software development pipelines.

Brayden Coggin. 2026 - Present. Analysis and security of software development pipelines.

Thai Nguyen. 2025 - 2026. Human factors in software engineering and analysis and security of software development pipelines.

Nikola Krstajic. 2025. Human factors in software engineering.

Michael Johnson. 2025 - Present. Human factors in software engineering and analysis and security of software development pipelines.

Layla Le. 2025. Human factors in software engineering.

Kenneth Valladares. 2025. Human factors in software engineering.

Julian Velez. 2025. Human factors in software engineering.

Jorge Toledo. 2025. Human factors in software engineering.

Hasini Daliboyina. 2025. Human factors in software engineering.

David Gusmao. 2025 - Present. Human factors in software engineering and analysis and security of software development pipelines.

Anju Thomas. 2025. Human factors in software engineering.

Adam Betinsky. 2025 - Present. Human factors in software engineering and analysis and security of software development pipelines.

Zachary Burkett. 2024. Semantics-aware translation of C preprocessor.

Joseph Zalusky. 2024. Semantics-aware translation of C preprocessor macros.

PROJECTS

- 2026 Foreman.** University of Central Florida. A Python tool that enables developer to specify the commands file access permissions of phase of a project's build system, to protect these phases against pipeline poisoning attacks. Foreman is the tool associated with 2026 ICSE NIER paper, *Build Code is Still Code: Finding the Antidote for Pipeline Poisoning*.
- 2024 Macroni.** Trail of Bits. A C static analysis tool that combines Trail of Bits' tools PASTA and VAST to lower C preprocessor macros down to MLIR. [GitHub](#).
- 2024 Maki.** University of Central Florida. A C++ Clang plugin that analyzes hows C preprocessor macros affect the C AST. Maki provides language porting tools information they can use to port macros to target languages in a way that preserves not just macro behavior, but also macro abstractions. Maki is the tool associated with 2024 ICSE paper, *Semantic Analysis of Macro Usage for Portability*, for which I am the lead-author. [GitHub](#).

SKILLS SUMMARY

Languages: Python3, C/C++, Bash, and HTML/CSS/JavaScript

Tools: Git, GitHub, and LLVM/Clang

Platforms: Linux, Web, and Windows

Soft Skills: Leadership, Writing, Communication, and Time management